PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET

How Explainable AI Influences Operator Trust and Decision Quality

Please read this sheet before deciding whether to take part. Keep a copy for your records.

RESEARCHER: COMPLETE BEFORE USE
Replace all bracketed fields and obtain institutional ethics approval before recruitment. This template is not an approval or legal compliance determination.

Researcher / data controller	[Name and institution]
Contact	[Researcher or institutional contact]
Ethics review	[Committee and approval/reference number or status]
Expected duration	About 15 minutes

Why is the study being done?

This study examines how different AI explanation styles relate to decisions, trust, confidence, and perceived workload in fictional monitoring situations. The results are intended for academic research.

What will I be asked to do?

You will complete three practice items and 30 fictional monitoring scenarios. You will see three explanation styles in randomized blocks, choose an action for each scenario, and answer short rating questions. At the end you will rate workload and may provide optional comments. No live AI is used. Recommendations are fixed research examples and may be incorrect; your choices do not affect real systems.

Who can take part?

Adults aged 18 years or older who can read the study language and freely provide consent. Do not take part if you are under 18.

Is participation voluntary?

Yes. You may stop before final submission by closing the page. To request deletion after submission, contact the researcher and provide your participant code or session ID if available. Withdrawal may not be possible after data are irreversibly anonymized or included in aggregate results. Withdrawal cut-off and procedure: **[Specify before recruitment]**.

YOUR DATA AND YOUR CHOICE

What information is collected?

A generated session ID, a participant code if entered (otherwise a random code), age group, country of residence, optional gender, education, AI and engineering/industry experience, scenario decisions, explanation condition, response times, ratings, workload scores, optional comments, consent timestamp, and completion timestamp. Do not include names or identifying details in free-text answers.

Where is information stored?

Responses are first saved in this browser. If the researcher enables Google Sheets collection, a copy is sent over HTTPS to a Google Apps Script endpoint and stored in a private Google Sheet controlled by the research team. The app itself does not request or store IP addresses, use tracking cookies, or send data to analytics services. Hosting, Google, and network providers may process technical connection data under their terms. The public submission endpoint can be called by anyone who has its URL; this prototype should not collect special-category or highly sensitive information.

Controller, lawful basis, and transfers

Controller: **[Institution / controller identity]**. Purpose: academic research on human interaction with AI recommendations. Lawful basis: **[Institution-approved GDPR lawful basis]**. Google may process submitted data as a service provider. International transfers and safeguards, if any: **[Specify after institutional review]**.

How long will information be kept?

Retention period and deletion schedule: **[Specify ethics-approved period and process]**. The browser copy can be deleted through the researcher dashboard or by clearing browser data. The research team will delete spreadsheet data and exports at the end of the stated period.

Your rights and complaints

Depending on the lawful basis and applicable law, you may have rights to access, correct, erase, restrict, object to, or receive data. Contact **[Data protection contact / DPO]** about your rights or contact **[Relevant supervisory authority]** to complain. If processing is based on consent, you can withdraw it without affecting processing already carried out. Coded-record withdrawal procedure: **[Specify]**.

Risks, benefits, and compensation

No direct benefit is promised. Some scenarios describe safety incidents or security alerts and may cause mild discomfort; you may stop at any time. The study is fictional and is not professional advice. Compensation: **[State amount or none]**.

Consent statement

By selecting the consent checkbox and continuing, you confirm you are at least 18, have read this information, understand participation is voluntary, and agree to the described research data processing. Keep this sheet and contact the researcher with questions.

Before recruitment: confirm this sheet, the online consent text, privacy notice, Google Sheet data flow, and ethics approval all describe the same study.